

Elasticity of Demand

- (i) Price elasticity of Demand
- (ii) Income elasticity of Demand
- (iii) Cross elasticity of Demand

→ Price elasticity of Demand

↳ shows the responsiveness of percentage change in demand due to the percentage change in price.

$$E_p / E_d = \frac{\text{Percentage change in } Q_d}{\text{Percentage change in Price}}$$

$$= \frac{\Delta Q / Q \times 100}{\Delta P / P \times 100}$$

$$= \frac{\Delta Q}{Q} \times \frac{P}{\Delta P}$$

$$\therefore E_p = \frac{\Delta Q}{\Delta P} \times \frac{P}{Q_1}; \quad E_p = \text{Price elasticity of demand}$$

ΔQ = change in demand

$= Q_2 - Q_1$; Q_2 = Current demand

Q_1 = initial demand

ΔP = change in Price
 $= P_2 - P_1$

Q Math-1: Suppose the price of a product increased from Tk 50 to Tk 75 and its demand has decreased by 100 units to 95 units.

(i) Calculate the price elasticity of demand.

(ii) Find out whether the demand for this good is elastic or inelastic.

$$\Delta Q > \Delta P$$

$$\Delta Q < \Delta P$$

(i)

Given,

$$\text{Initial Price } (P_1) = \text{Tk } 50$$

$$\text{Current Price } (P_2) = \text{Tk } 75$$

$$\text{Initial Demand } (Q_1) = 100 \text{ units}$$

$$\text{Current Demand } (Q_2) = 95 \text{ unit}$$

Now,

$$E_P = \frac{\Delta Q}{\Delta P} \times \frac{P}{Q}$$

$$= \frac{95 - 100}{75 - 50} \times \frac{50}{100}$$

$$= -0.1$$

Interpretation:

If price increases from Tk 50 to Tk 75 demand has decreased by 0.1 Percent.

(ii)

From the above calculation, $E_P = -0.1$

Setting the value in modulus we get,

$$|E_P| = |-0.1| = 0.1 \text{ which is less than } 1.$$

Rules,

If, $|E_P| > 1 \rightarrow$ the demand is elastic

If, $|E_P| < 1 \rightarrow$ the demand is inelastic

If, $|E_P| = 1 \rightarrow$ the demand is unit elastic

Therefore, in question, the demand for this good is inelastic.

Income Elasticity of demand

$$E_Y = \frac{\Delta Q}{\Delta Y} \times \frac{Y}{Q}$$

$\begin{cases} Y \uparrow D \uparrow \\ (+) \text{ Normal goods} \\ Y \uparrow D \downarrow \\ (-) \text{ Inferior good} \end{cases}$

▣ Suppose, the income of a person increased from Tk 50000 to Tk 70000 and his demand has decreased by 100 unit to 95 unit.

(i) Calculate the income elasticity of demand

(ii) Find out whether the good in question is a normal or inferior good.

Given,

Initial income (Y_1) = 50000 Tk

Current " (Y_2) = 70000 Tk

Initial Demand (Q_1) = 100 unit

Current " (Q_2) = 95 unit

Now,

$$E_Y = \frac{\Delta Q}{\Delta Y} \times \frac{Y}{Q}$$
$$= \frac{95 - 100}{70000 - 50000} \times \frac{50000}{100}$$

$$\therefore E_Y = -0.125$$

Interpretation:

if income increased from Tk 50000 to Tk 70000 demand has decreased by 0.125 Percent.

(ii)

From the above calculation $E_Y = -0.125$, which is a negative number.

Rules:

if E_Y is Positive the good is normal good

if E_Y is negative the good is inferior good.

Therefore, the good given in question is an inferior good.

Cross Elasticity of demand

$$E_c = \frac{\Delta Q_{\text{coffee}}}{\Delta P_{\text{Tea}}} \times \frac{P_{\text{Tea}}}{Q_{\text{coffee}}}$$

Tea Coffee (+) → Substitutes
P↑ D↑
Milk Coffee (-) → Complement
P↑ D↓

□ Suppose the price of Tehari increased from Tk 150/Pack to Tk 300/Pack and as a result, the demand of Kacchi has increased from 300 units to 500 units.

- (i) Calculate the Cross elasticity of demand.
- (ii) Find out whether the inter-related goods in question are substitutes or complement.

(i) Given,

Initial Price of Tehari (P_1) = Tk 150/Pack

Current " " " (P_2) = Tk 300/Pack

Initial demand of Kacchi (Q_1) = 300 units

Current " " " (Q_2) = 500 units

We know,

$$E_c = \frac{\Delta Q_{\text{kacchi}}}{\Delta P_{\text{Tehari}}} \times \frac{P_{\text{Tehari}}}{Q_{\text{kacchi}}}$$

$$= \frac{500 - 300}{300 - 150} \times \frac{150}{300}$$

$$= 0.67$$

Interpretation:

If the price of Tehari increased from Tk 150/pack to Tk 300/pack the demand for kacchi increased 0.67 Percent.

(ii)

From the above calculation $E_c = 0.67$ which is a positive number.

Rules:

if E_c is positive the inter-related goods are substitute.

if E_c is negative the inter-related goods are Complement.

Therefore the inter-related goods in question are substitute.